



VELVET DINOSAUR

Practical Website Audit for IDEA

A short evidence-backed review of the International Development Ethics Association website, focused on trust, current activity, membership, resources, and mobile basics.

Prepared for	International Development Ethics Association
Prepared by	Ian Wickens, Velvet Dinosaur
Date	May 21, 2026

Executive Summary

IDEA's site already communicates the association's intellectual purpose and has the core pages a visitor expects: About, officers, bylaws, events, resources, membership, and contact. The main opportunity is not to add more content. It is to make the existing content feel current, trustworthy, and easier to act on.

39

public sitemap pages
crawled

0

failed internal links from
62 checked

70

non-OK external link
responses from 189
checked

The most urgent fixes are accuracy issues: placeholder contact information, old membership contact details, duplicate membership URLs, and a public event link that points to a Google Sites edit URL.

What To Fix First

PRIORITY	FIX	WHY IT MATTERS
1	Remove placeholder details from Contact	Placeholder contact information damages trust immediately.
2	Correct the Joining IDEA contact	The membership page should not send people to an old officer if the footer names a different secretary.
3	Choose one canonical Joining IDEA URL	The navigation points to <code>/joining-idea/</code> , while the sitemap also includes newer <code>/joining-idea-2/</code> .
4	Replace the Google Sites edit URL on Past Events	Visitors should never be sent to an edit/admin-style URL.
5	Repair resource and archive links	External link rot is visible enough to affect confidence in the site.
6	Add a current activity panel to the homepage	New visitors need to know whether IDEA is active now and where to go next.

Visitor Journey Findings

First-Time Visitor

The homepage explains IDEA's purpose and includes a strong short introduction to development ethics. It says the website provides news about recent and future discussions and research, but the page does not show a recent event, current call, newsletter, or next practical step.

Add a small homepage section with Current activity, Join IDEA, Resources, and Contact. If there is no current event, say that plainly and invite visitors to join the mailing list or contact the secretary.

Membership

The Joining IDEA page is useful and the external payment link to Philosophy Documentation Center returned HTTP 200. The issue is consistency.

The site has both `/joining-idea/` and `/joining-idea-2/`. The navigation points to `/joining-idea/`, while `/joining-idea-2/` is the newer sitemap entry. Both pages direct contributing-membership requests to Anna Malavisi at `malavisi@msu.edu`. The footer and Officers Board identify Jack Simpson as IDEA Secretary at `jh10j3s@leeds.ac.uk`.

Keep one membership URL, redirect the other, update the contact, and add a short How to join summary above the long text.

Contact

The Contact page currently shows placeholder information: `10 Street Road, City, 10100, mail@example.com`, and `(555) 555 1234`. The real secretary contact appears only later in the global footer.

Remove the placeholder address, email, and phone immediately. Replace the page with one clear contact route for Jack Simpson, or temporarily remove the Contact page until it is accurate.

News And Events

The site has substantial historical material, but current and archive content are mixed together. The sitemap shows that 27 of 39 public pages were last modified in 2022 or earlier. The News and Events page was last modified in 2021 and begins with 2022 and 2018 content.

Split News and Events into Current and Archive. Put dates on every listing and mark old congress, webinar, and prize pages as archive material.

Member Resources

Member Resources is a useful starting point, but it reads like a list rather than a maintained resource library. Some items are visible text without links, such as Audio and Syllabus. The UN Training in Human Development link returned HTTP 404.

Rebuild resources into a small library with sections for Reading, Teaching, Video/Audio, Courses, and Partner links. Add descriptions and review dates for external links.

Officers And Trust Signals

The Officers Board page contains important leadership information, but the mobile experience is long and image-heavy. Lighthouse measured the Officers Board mobile page at 5,455 KiB total page weight, 23.4 s Largest Contentful Paint, and a 66 performance score.

Use compact mobile person rows or cards with image, name, role, and optional affiliation. Optimize portrait images to display size.

Technical Quality

What Is Working

- Internal links checked cleanly: 62 checked, 0 failed.
- Basic SEO scores were strong in local Lighthouse checks.
- Best Practices scores were 100 on the homepage and Joining IDEA page.
- The site has a robots file and public sitemap.

What Needs Attention

External links need review. Of 189 checked external URLs, 70 returned non-OK status or failed to connect. This included 23 HTTP 404s, 2 HTTP 410s, expired certificate failures, and timeouts. Some 403 responses may be caused by bot protection or access controls, so they should be reviewed before removal.

Confirmed examples include:

- <https://medellin.travel/en/destinations/santa-fe-de-antioquia> returned 404.
- <https://dl.dropboxusercontent.com/u/36043317/IDEA/IDEAmini-conferenceProgram%20NASSP.pdf> returned 404.
- <http://hdr.undp.org/en/nhdr/training/> returned 404.
- <http://www.brynmawr.edu/internationalstudies/idea/> returned 404.
- http://www.inif.ucr.ac.cr/congreso_inif/docs/MEMORIA.pdf returned 404.

Lighthouse Snapshot

PAGE	MODE	PERF.	ACCESS.	SEO	NOTES
Homepage	Desktop	85	95	100	LCP 2.7 s
Homepage	Mobile	n/a	96	100	LCP 15.8 s; performance score unavailable due Lighthouse trace issue
Joining IDEA	Desktop	85	93	100	LCP 2.7 s
Joining IDEA	Mobile	65	94	100	LCP 15.4 s
Officers Board	Mobile	66	96	100	LCP 23.4 s; total weight 5,455 KiB

The repeated accessibility issue is an unnamed footer image link. Fixing the footer logo link would be a small, high-confidence improvement.

Recommended 30-Day Action Plan

Week 1: Trust And Accuracy

- Remove placeholder Contact details.
- Update the Joining IDEA contact conflict.
- Set one canonical Joining IDEA URL.
- Replace the Google Sites edit URL.
- Fix the unnamed footer image link.

Week 2: Current Activity

- Add a homepage current activity panel.
- Separate active News and Events from archive content.
- Add dates and archive labels to older event pages.

Week 3: Resources And Links

- Review external links on Member Resources, Past Events, News and Events, and About.
- Replace dead links where better current URLs exist.
- Archive pages that cannot be fully maintained.

Week 4: Mobile Polish

- Compress and resize portraits, hero, and footer images.
- Convert the Officers Board page into a more compact mobile layout.

- Re-run Lighthouse and a link check.

Closing Note

IDEA already has the right core material: purpose, history, officers, membership, events, and resources. The quickest improvement is accuracy and currency. Fixing contact details, membership guidance, archive labeling, and link maintenance would make the site feel more reliable without requiring a full redesign.

Prepared by Ian Wickens, Velvet Dinosaur. Evidence captured from the live public site on May 21, 2026.